Project Report: Digital Literacy Portfolio

Course Code: CSE0001

Course Title: Digital Literacy Student

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Branch: B. Tech (cyber security), First Year

Date: March 31, 2026

Introduction:-

As a newly appointed Student Digital Ambassador, I have developed this portfolio to guide my peers through the essential skills required in a modern academic and professional environment. Digital literacy is more than just operating a computer; it involves finding and evaluating information, ensuring online safety, and maintaining a professional digital footprint. This project outlines five critical tasks: creating a visual awareness resource, building a professional portfolio, mastering collaboration tools, practicing professional communication, and advocating for cybercrime awareness

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Task 1: Digital Literacy Awareness Infographic

For this task, I designed a comprehensive visual resource titled "Digital Literacy" to help batchmates understand the core pillars of modern technology use. The design covers five distinct areas: what digital literacy is, useful digital tools, safe internet practices, professional online presence, and email etiquette. The infographic highlights that digital literacy involves using technology effectively and understanding online safety. Under "Useful Digital Tools," I categorized resources into Research Tools, Productivity Apps, and Cloud Storage to provide a roadmap for academic success. The section on safe internet practices emphasizes the use of strong passwords and being wary of scams. To address career readiness, I included tips for building a professional online reputation, specifically mentioning LinkedIn. Finally, I detailed four key email etiquette tips: using clear subject lines, being professional, checking grammar, and replying politely. I used a visual design tool to create a layout that is both professional and easy to navigate for students. One interesting aspect of creating this was learning how to condense complex safety information into simple, actionable bullet points. The most difficult part was balancing the visual hierarchy to ensure that critical safety warnings, like the "Safe Internet Practices" section, stood out without overshadowing the productivity tips.

Task 2: Building a Student Digital Portfolio In the second module

I established a foundational digital presence across three key platforms: GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle. Each platform serves a unique purpose in my growth as an cyber student.

• Kaggle: I set up my profile with the tagline "Learn from the best, code with the rest". I plan to use this platform to move from a general student to a technical practitioner by focusing on data science notebooks and specialized areas like Computer Vision.

• GitHub: My GitHub profile features a clean layout highlighting my branch as CSE (cyber) at VIT Bhopal. My goal is to maintain a professional README that signals my expertise in Object Detection and mathematical foundations.

• LinkedIn: My LinkedIn profile includes a professional headshot and a "Data/AI" themed banner. Currently, it links to VIT Bhopal University and features my specific skills in Python and Machine Learning. Over the next four years, I plan to use these platforms as a living portfolio. GitHub will track my daily progress through "green squares" of code commits, Kaggle will be my playground for competitive data analysis, and LinkedIn will serve as my primary networking tool to connect with professionals in the AI industry. My strategy is to pivot from a "University Student" to "Hireable AIML Talent" by consistently documenting my projects and certifications.

Task 3: Coding and Collaboration Platforms

This task focused on technical skill-building and digital collaboration using HackerRank and Google Forms. In Part A, I utilized HackerRank to practice logical problem-solving. I successfully completed several beginner-level challenges, including "Solve Me First," "loops," "Arithematic operator ," and "A Very Big Sum". These exercises allowed me to earn a Problem Solving Bronze Badge. This practice is vital as an cyber student because it bridges the gap between theoretical algorithms and actual Python implementation. In Part B, I designed a five-question "Digital Literacy Awareness Quiz" using Google Forms to test my peers' knowledge of essential digital skills. The quiz included multiplechoice questions on password strength and short-answer questions identifying phishing attempts. I also integrated a Google Sheet to capture real-time responses, which allowed for efficient data analysis. Designing the quiz taught me that clear question structure is the key to obtaining highquality data. For example, asking respondents to define "URL" or rate their confidence in managing privacy settings provides measurable insights into the digital literacy levels of our batch. Academically, mastering these cloud-based tools is essential for future datadriven research and collaborative group projects.

Task 4: Professional Email and Etiquette

Professional communication is a cornerstone of digital literacy. For this module, I drafted two essential emails and established a social media conduct guide. The first email was a request to a professor for an assignment extension due to technical difficulties with a development environment. I ensured the subject line was clear ("Request for Extension: Assignment Submission – Nagaruthik Muddisetty – 25BCY10246") and the tone remained respectful and professional. The second email was an inquiry to an internship coordinator, expressing interest in a summer opportunity and highlighting my skills in Python and my digital portfolio on GitHub. In addition to formal emails, I developed a Social Media Do's and Don'ts checklist for college students:

• Do's: Think before you post, keep personal info private, use social media for learning, respect others' opinions, and verify info before sharing.

• Don'ts: Don’t share fake news, don’t post offensive content, don’t waste too much time scrolling, don’t share passwords, and don’t engage in online bullying. A critical learning from this task is that poor digital communication can lead to significant real-world problems. For instance, a hypothetical scenario where a student posts an unprofessional comment about their institution could lead to disciplinary action or the loss of a job offer. Using the "Think before you post" rule and maintaining a professional tone in all digital interactions can prevent such outcomes and build a positive long-term reputation.

Task 5: Cybercrime Awareness and Prevention

While researching this topic, what surprised me the most was how simple tricks are used to carry out serious cybercrimes. Many scams do not require advanced hacking skills; instead, they rely on

human mistakes like trusting unknown calls or clicking fake links. I was especially shocked to learn how easily people lose money through UPI fraud just by approving a request without understanding it.

As a result, one habit I will personally change is being more cautious before taking any action online, especially related to payments. I will make sure to verify every request carefully and never share sensitive information like OTPs or PINs. This awareness will help me stay safer and also guide others around me to avoid such risks.

Some more safety tips:-

• UPI Safety: Never approve unknown UPI collect requests (requesting money is a common scam).

• UPI Safety: Do not scan random QR codes to receive money; you only scan to pay.

• Avoid using public Wi-Fi for financial transactions.

• Report fraud immediately on the National Cyber Crime Portal (cybercrime.gov.in) or call 1930.
Researching this topic surprised me by showing how sophisticated UPI scams have become, especially the trick of using "Request Money" to steal funds. As a result, I will personally change my habit of scanning QR codes without first verifying the sender's identity.

Conclusion :-

Completing this project has significantly improved my confidence in navigating the digital world. From mastering professional platforms like GitHub and LinkedIn to understanding the critical nuances of financial safety and professional communication, I am now better equipped to serve as a Student Digital Ambassador. These skills are not just academic requirements but essential tools for a successful career in Artificial Intelligence and Machine Learning

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References:-

• **VITyarthi E-Learning Platform:** CSE0001 Project Assignment Brief.

• **National Cyber Crime Portal**: cybercrime.gov.in.

• **Platforms Used**: Canva, GitHub, LinkedIn, Kaggle, HackerRank, Google Forms, and Gmail